

Floor Cleaning SOP

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Applies to: All services — always **vacuum first, mop second** on hard surfaces

Time target: Regular 20–30 min whole home | Deep 30–45 min (includes edges and baseboards)

Purpose

Floors are the last task in every room and the whole home. Clean floors make or break the client's impression. Match method to floor type — one wrong product can damage surfaces permanently.

Supplies

- ☐ Vacuum with hose, crevice tool, and brush attachment
 - ☐ Mop system (microfiber flat mop preferred)
 - ☐ Bucket OR spray-mop with refillable solution
 - ☐ pH-neutral hard floor cleaner
 - ☐ Carpet spot cleaner (optional)
 - ☐ Dry microfiber pad for final buff
 - ☐ "Wet floor" caution if client has pets/elderly (optional sign)
-

Universal Rule: Vacuum → Mop

Hard surfaces (hardwood, tile, LVP, laminate):

1. ☐ Vacuum entire floor including edges and under furniture edges
2. ☐ Mop with appropriate cleaner — damp, not soaking
3. ☐ Dry buff high-traffic areas if needed

Carpet:

1. ☐ Vacuum only — no mopping
2. ☐ Use crevice tool at carpet-to-baseboard edges
3. ☐ Spot treat stains only if in scope and product-safe

Never mop before vacuuming — you'll push debris and scratch floors.

Whole-Home Floor Order

- ☐ Complete all dry work (dusting, counters, beds) before any mopping
 - ☐ Vacuum all carpeted areas first
 - ☐ Vacuum all hard floors (pick up debris mop would spread)
 - ☐ Mop hard floors **back to front, far corner toward exit**
 - ☐ Start at back of house; finish at entry door
 - ☐ Do not walk back across wet floors
-

Floor Type Guide

Hardwood (Sealed)

- ☐ Vacuum with hard floor setting or brush off
- ☐ Mop with **pH-neutral hardwood cleaner** — damp microfiber only
- ☐ Wring mop until barely damp — water is hardwood's enemy
- ☐ Mop with the grain when possible
- ☐ Dry buff with clean microfiber if streaks appear

Do NOT: Soak floors, use steam mop on unsealed wood, use vinegar on waxed floors, use abrasive pads.

Tile & Grout

- ☐ Vacuum or sweep to remove grit (grit scratches tile)
- ☐ Mop with all-purpose or tile cleaner
- ☐ Change mop water when gray
- ☐ Deep clean: hand-scrub grout lines in kitchen and entry

Do NOT: Use bleach on colored grout without testing. Avoid acid cleaners on natural stone tile.

LVP / Vinyl Plank / Laminate

- ☐ Vacuum with hard floor setting — no beater bar on loose planks
- ☐ Mop **lightly damp** — laminate swells with excess water
- ☐ Use manufacturer-approved or pH-neutral cleaner
- ☐ Never let water sit in seams or edges

Do NOT: Steam mop on laminate (unless manufacturer explicitly allows). No wax or polish.

Carpet

- ☐ Slow, overlapping vacuum passes — 2 directions in high traffic
- ☐ Crevice tool: edges along baseboards, stairs, and under furniture lips
- ☐ Move lightweight furniture (dining chairs, ottomans) if in scope
- ☐ Spot treat with carpet cleaner — blot, never rub
- ☐ Pet hair: vacuum slow; use rubber glove or pet tool if heavy

Do NOT: Over-wet carpet. No bleach. Don't guarantee stain removal.

Area Rugs on Hard Floor

- ☐ Roll edge or lift corner to vacuum under rug edge
 - ☐ Vacuum rug top, then flip if client allows (deep clean)
 - ☐ Vacuum hard floor beneath before replacing rug
-

Edge & Detail Work

Clients notice edges. Every deep clean and move-out includes:

- ☐ Crevice tool along all baseboards on carpet
 - ☐ Vacuum under couch and bed **lip** (don't move heavy furniture alone)
 - ☐ Kitchen: under toe-kick if vacuum hose reaches
 - ☐ Stairs: vacuum each tread, crevice at wall edge, mop hard stair treads if applicable
 - ☐ Entry mat — lift and clean under
-

Mop Technique

- ☐ Fill bucket with clean solution per product dilution
 - ☐ Dip and **wring thoroughly** — floors should dry in 2–5 minutes
 - ☐ Mop in figure-8 or S-pattern, overlapping passes
 - ☐ Change water when dirty or every 2–3 rooms
 - ☐ Rinse mop head between rooms on deep cleans
 - ☐ Exit room and let dry before closing door
-

Quality Standards

Floors pass when:

- ☐ No visible crumbs, hair, or debris on any surface
 - ☐ Hard floors are not sticky or cloudy with residue
 - ☐ Carpet shows vacuum lines in main traffic areas
 - ☐ Edges along baseboards are clean (deep/move-out)
 - ☐ No wet footprints left behind when you lock up
-

Do NOT (Floors)

- **✗** Use one mop water for the entire house on deep cleans
 - **✗** Mop yourself into a room with no exit
 - **✗** Use bleach mop solution on hardwood or LVP
 - **✗** Drag vacuum cord across wet floors
 - **✗** Leave kitchen mat down and mop around it — lift and clean under
 - **✗** Rush carpet vacuum — one fast pass is not a clean
 - **✗** Use steam on floors without confirming type with client/notes
-

Service-Specific Notes

Service	Floor Expectation
Regular (\$150)	Vacuum all; mop all hard surfaces
Deep (\$300)	+ edges, under furniture lips, grout if tile
Move-out	+ closet floors, garage sweep, pristine edges

Airbnb	Fast but complete — check entry and under dining table
--------	--

100% Cleaner — Vacuum first. Mop last. Exit dry.